

Twenty - First Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 23rd August 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -

Anniversary Mass: For Adrian Robinson on Sunday 30th August at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) - DDS Mass for deceased members on Saturday 22nd August at 6pm.

Anniversary Mass -

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Joseph's Church in August.

Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after Mass until 2.30pm.

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Requiescant In Pace: We extend our sympathy to the family and relatives of Tommy Johnson, formerly Lyttlesdale who died during the week.

Baptism: We welcome into the parish community Donnacha Robert O'Loughlin, 16 Churchtown Road who was baptised last weekend.

Parish Pastoral Group: Next meeting to prepare for the Parish Mission will take place on Tuesday 1st September in the Parochial House at 8.30pm.

Parish Mission: Parishioners may have heard that the parish will hold a mission in September of this year. It will be delivered by the Dominican Order. As you know it has been some time since the last Mission in the parish. Whilst members of the Parish Pastoral Group continue to organise it, it would be helpful to have a few interested individuals from each end of the parish to help with the organisation. Time commitment should not be great - a few hours between now and September and some input during the week itself. This is a great opportunity to get involved in a significant event for the parish, and if you are interested, please contact Fr. Crowley.

Parish Mission - Sunday 27th September - Friday 2nd October.

Errigal SVP: School Uniform Support: As the new school year approaches, we know that the cost of school uniforms can place a significant financial burden on many families. If you or someone you know needs assistance with the cost of school uniforms, please don't hesitate to contact your local **St Vincent de Paul (SVP Errigal)** in confidence.

Telephone: 07563595868 All enquiries will be treated with sensitivity, respect and complete confidentiality.

Errigal SVP: Could You Spare a Little Time to Help Others? As we prepare to celebrate the Feast of St Vincent de Paul (27th September), the Errigal St Vincent de Paul (SVP) Conference need a couple of volunteers to join our local team. This is a wonderful opportunity to put your faith into action, give something back to our community, and make a real difference to the lives of local individuals and families who are struggling. No previous experience is necessary. You will be warmly welcomed and fully supported by our local SVP Volunteers, with guidance and training provided. If you would like to find out more, please contact us on 07563595868. We'd be delighted to hear from you. For more details, please see <https://www.svp.ie/northern-ireland/>

Errigal: Through Our Eyes - Summer Youth Photography Project: Starting Monday 6th July, all young people under 18 are invited to join Errigal: Through Our Eyes, a summer photography project. The theme is "See what matters. See where God is." This will celebrate the beauty, faith, kindness, and everyday life of our parish. Pick up an entry form, then send up to three photos taken within the parish boundaries and a short reflection to the parish email (with parent/guardian consent for under-16s). There are 1st, 2nd and 3rd place prizes in both Primary and Secondary categories, with certificates for everyone. **Update Deadline - Please note that the closing date for entries has been postponed until the end of September. We warmly encourage all our young people to take part and share their photographs and reflections. More details will follow soon.**

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 5th September in St. Mary's Church at 5pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 13th September at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 2nd September at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Saturday 28th August using the parish email address, this will indicate to the Baptismal Team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference 2026 - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope' The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is delighted to be hosting its third Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'. The conference will take place over two days in Saint Columb's College, Derry, with over 1200 delegates attending. Tuesday 25th August is the day for Post-Primary Schools and Wednesday 26th August is the day for Primary Schools. We are delighted to welcome Dr Melodie Wyttenbach, Executive Director, Roche Centre for Catholic Education, Boston College as our keynote speaker. Bishop Donal McKeown will celebrate the Eucharist at the beginning of the conference each day. Alongside Dr Wyttenbach's keynote address, there will be 20 workshops, a panel discussion and the opportunity for attendees to meet and share their experiences and good practice.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Gift Aid/Census Cards: Can we please request the return of Gift Aid and Census cards recently circulated so that parish records can be updated during the summer months.

Rosary and Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament: Will continue through the summer months on the first Monday of each month. St. Joseph's Church - 7pm.

Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference 2026 - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'

- The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is delighted to be hosting its third Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'. The conference will take place over two days in Saint Columb's College, Derry. Tuesday 25th August is the day for Post-Primary Schools and Wednesday 26th August is the day for Primary Schools. We are delighted to welcome Dr Melodie Wyttenbach, Executive Director, Roche Centre for Catholic Education, Boston College as our keynote speaker. Bishop Donal McKeown will celebrate the Eucharist at the beginning of the conference each day. Alongside Dr Wyttenbach's keynote address, there will be 20 workshops, a panel discussion and the opportunity for attendees to meet and share their experiences and good practice. If you would like to register your intention to attend, please complete the form below. Once you have registered, you will receive a list of workshops to choose from.

<https://forms.office.com/e/wskcEL79LY?origin=lpLink>

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 183 boxes of envelopes in circulation.

Returns (Pink/Yellow - 85 White - 65)

St. Mary's - Parish: £400 Renovation: £110

St. Joseph's - Parish: £450 Renovation: £450

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 8, 25, 27, 28. Jackpot is £2500. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Knight Family.

Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 3, 15, 22, 29. Jackpot £10,000. £25 winners - Majella McCloskey, Peter Doherty, Joanne O'Kane, Gerard McAfee, and Edel Mullan.

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Seamus O'Kane.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Martina Bradley & Gillian O'Neill.

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Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil - Gerard O'Kane.

Sunday Morning - Michael Leadon.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead Mc Nicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil - Rosellen O'Kane & Mary Conway.

Sunday Morning - Ursula Mullan & Nadine McNicholl.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - St. Bartholomew: Name occurs in the Synoptic Gospels only in the list of the apostles. He is probably to be identified with Nathanael of Cana, whom Philip brings to our Lord. Preached the Gospel in India. **Tuesday - St. Louis (1214 - 70):** King of France, father of eleven children, Franciscan tertiary, man of integrity, died in Tunisia on his second Crusade. He is the Patron of the French Monarchy. **Thursday - St. Monica (332 - 87):** Converted her pagan husband, Patricius, to the faith, and by her prayers and tears brought her son St. Augustine to Christianity and a moral life. Patron saint of mothers. **Friday - St. Augustine (354 - 430):** Bishop of Hippo, where he lived with a community until his death. His theological influence has been most significant in the Church, especially on the understanding of God's grace. Patron of theologians. **Saturday - Passion of John the Baptist:** He is found worthy of a martyr's death, his last and greatest act of witness to Christ.

Diocesan Vocations: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - '**The Word of the Lord**' as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at:
<https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray>.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters*' - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titled Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed - <https://youtube.com/@parishoferrigalderry>.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims, Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £235,400.00.

Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link: <https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care-freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/>

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you

do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on <https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/>

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.



St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar [07841407154](tel:07841407154).

St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media

outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website: www.synod.ie**



Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**

If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.

Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.

We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.

Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:

(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) **Errigal Development:** Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c).

(Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) **(Errigal Parish:** Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).

Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.

Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: <https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/> is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O’Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.

Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.

Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary’s Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph’s Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary’s Church.